

Global Code of Conduct & Ethics

NovaTech Industries | *"Doing the Right Thing, Every Time"*

1. Introduction & Our Ethical Foundation

At NovaTech Industries, how we achieve our business goals is just as important as the goals themselves. Our Global Code of Conduct is the cornerstone of our corporate culture. It serves as our ethical compass, outlining the unwavering standards of behavior expected from every employee, contractor, consultant, and board member across our global operations. We believe that integrity is non-negotiable.

2. Respect in the Workplace

We are dedicated to maintaining a supportive, inclusive, and professional environment. We treat each other with dignity and respect. Bullying, intimidation, microaggressions, and any form of physical or verbal violence are strictly prohibited. We celebrate diversity of thought, background, and experience, believing it drives our innovation.

3. Conflicts of Interest

A conflict of interest arises when your personal, social, financial, or political interests interfere—or even appear to interfere—with your loyalty and objectivity toward NovaTech. You must avoid any relationship or activity that impairs your ability to make fair decisions. Examples include:

- Having a substantial financial interest in a supplier, customer, or competitor.
- Hiring or supervising a close relative or romantic partner without HR oversight.
- Using company property, confidential information, or your corporate position for personal gain.
- Serving as a board member or consultant for another company without prior written approval.

All potential conflicts, no matter how minor they seem, must be disclosed immediately to your manager and the Compliance Office via the Ethics Portal.

4. Anti-Bribery and Corruption

NovaTech has a strict zero-tolerance policy towards bribery and corruption in any form. We compete based solely on the merit of our products and services. We comply strictly with the US Foreign Corrupt Practices Act (FCPA), the UK Bribery Act, and all local anti-corruption laws wherever we operate. You must never offer, promise, authorize, give, or accept money, gifts, kickbacks, or anything of value to improperly influence a business decision, government official, or to gain an unfair advantage.

5. Gifts, Entertainment, and Hospitality

Business gifts and entertainment can help build goodwill, but they must never cloud business judgment. They are acceptable only if they are reasonable, proportionate, infrequent, and for a legitimate business purpose. The guidelines are:

- Gifts valued under \$50 USD are generally acceptable and do not require reporting.
- Gifts valued over \$50 USD must be logged in the Global Gift Register and explicitly approved by your Department Head and regional Compliance Officer.
- Cash, cash equivalents (like Visa gift cards), and loans are strictly prohibited, regardless of value.
- During a competitive bidding process or contract negotiation, all gift-giving and receiving must cease entirely.

6. Confidentiality, Data Privacy, and Insider Trading

6.1 Protecting Information

Protecting NovaTech's proprietary information, source code, financial data, and the personal data of our clients and employees is critical. You must handle all personal data in strict compliance with GDPR, CCPA, and our internal Data Privacy Framework. Do not discuss sensitive company matters in public places like elevators or airplanes.

6.2 Insider Trading

During the course of your work, you may learn material, non-public information about NovaTech, our clients, or our partners. Trading stocks or securities based on this "inside information," or tipping off others to do so, is not just a violation of this code—it is a criminal offense.

7. Social Media & Public Communications

We respect your right to use social media personally. However, always be mindful that you represent NovaTech. Do not disclose confidential company information, disparage competitors, or speak on behalf of the company unless specifically authorized by the PR department. If you mention your employment at NovaTech, make it clear that your opinions are your own.

8. Reporting Concerns (Whistleblower Protection)

Integrity requires courage. If you observe or suspect a violation of this Code, company policy, or the law, you have a duty to speak up. You can report concerns through several channels:

- Your direct manager or next-level supervisor.
- Your HR Business Partner.
- Anonymously via our 24/7 independent Ethics Hotline at 1-800-NOVA-ETHICS, or online at ethics.novatech.com.

Zero Retaliation: NovaTech strictly prohibits retaliation against anyone who reports a concern in good faith or cooperates with an investigation. Anyone found engaging in retaliation will face severe disciplinary action, up to and including termination.